

Project Scout

Play Store Launch Checklist

What Scout needs to be worth \$9.99 | Created June 10, 2026

Scout does not need to be perfect to ship. He needs to be reliable, honest, and feel like a companion. Everything on this list makes him worth \$9.99 to a family who has never met him before. Everything NOT on this list can come in an update.

■ Already Done — Scout Has These Today

- ✓ **Animated face** — Eyes that move, blink, and show emotion. Looks alive. Looks like Scout.
- ✓ **Voice — speaks and listens** — Scout hears you and talks back. Android STT + TTS, works offline.
- ✓ **Camera awareness** — Scout sees faces and scenes. Knows when someone is there.
- ✓ **Offline brain** — TinyLlama 1.1B runs fully on the phone. No internet required for basic conversation.
- ✓ **Flexible memory** — Scout learns and recalls any fact — favorite color, names, anything. Not hardcoded.
- ✓ **Identity answers** — Scout answers 'are you my friend?' and 'can you hear me?' as Scout, not a generic AI.
- ✓ **Weather** — Current conditions, tonight, tomorrow, 7-day, precipitation %. Works offline with honest refusal.
- ✓ **Total offline mode** — 'Go offline' blocks ALL internet features. Private by design.
- ✓ **Thinking expression** — Eyes drift, lids narrow, brows go asymmetric while Scout thinks. Quietly alive.
- ✓ **Business model** — \$9.99 one-time purchase. No subscriptions. Optional support tiers. Ad-free forever.

■ Must Fix Before Launch

These are the real blockers. Scout cannot ship without these.

1 Wake word filter

URGENT — makes Scout livable

Scout currently listens to everything — the TV, family conversations, background noise — and TinyLlama tries to answer all of it. Scout should only respond when he hears his name. This is the single most important fix before launch. An annoying companion is worse than no companion at all. Important: build this to read the name from TruthDb, not hardcoded as 'Scout' — so when a family renames him 'Max', the wake word automatically becomes 'Max'.

■ [ScoutIntentRouter.kt](#) + [MainActivity.kt](#) — one focused session

2 Memory recall bug

Makes Scout feel trustworthy

Scout remembers a fact correctly but only recalls it if asked immediately after teaching. If another question comes first, recall falls through to TinyLlama. The fix is in the regex pattern inside `handleRecallIntent()` — it

is too strict. One surgical CTRL-R fix.

■ [MainActivity.kt — handleRecallIntent\(\) — one surgical edit](#)

3 Remove hardcoded Gemini API key

[RELEASE BLOCKER — protects you](#)

Your personal Gemini API key is currently baked into the app code. Anyone who downloads Scout from the Play Store could extract it and use your quota. Google could bill you or shut your key down. The `ApiKeySetupActivity.kt` wizard is already built — it just needs to be connected so Scout reads the user's own key from secure storage instead.

■ [MainActivity.kt + ApiKeySetupActivity.kt — one focused session](#)

4 Basic Settings screen

[Minimum needed to ship](#)

Scout needs at least: API key entry (so users can add their own Gemini key), offline mode toggle, and robot name display. The Settings Master Plan is already designed. This is the minimum viable settings screen — not the full vision, just enough to ship.

■ [New SettingsActivity.kt — one focused session](#)

5 Startup diagnostics

[Makes Scout start cleanly every time](#)

Scout should check at startup that the brain is loaded, TTS is ready, and STT is available — and say something friendly if something is missing rather than silently failing or crashing. This protects against bad first impressions and bad reviews.

■ [MainActivity.kt — startup check block](#)

6 A32 stability testing

[Protects against bad reviews](#)

The Samsung Galaxy A32 is Scout's stress-test device — the minimum spec phone. Before launching, run Scout on the A32 for a full session. Test voice, memory, offline brain, and weather. If it runs stably on a 2021 budget phone, it will run on almost anything.

■ [Test session on A32 — no code, just validation](#)

■ Play Store Listing

These are not code — but they are required to submit to Google Play.

■ **App description** — Plain English, family-friendly. Lead with 'Turn an old phone into a friend.' Honest about what Scout is and is not.

■ **Screenshots** — Scout's face, the settings screen, a weather response, a memory recall moment. 5–8 screenshots minimum.

■ **Privacy policy** — Required by Google. One clear page: no data leaves the device, no accounts required, no ads ever.

■ **Content rating questionnaire** — Google asks questions about content. Scout is family-safe — this should be straightforward.

■ **Short description** — 60 characters max. Something like: 'A calm AI companion for your whole family. Private. Local. Yours.'

■ After Launch — Update 1.1 and Beyond

These are real and important — but they are NOT launch blockers. Scout ships without them and adds them as updates. This is normal. This is healthy.

- Proposal Sandbox — 'Want me to remember that?' confirm step before saving
- Permanent vs temporary memory — birthday vs appointment sorting
- Caring follow-up loop — 'How was your appointment?' then forget
- Full mood system — CALM / CURIOUS / HAPPY / THINKING / CONCERNED wired in
- Spanish language support — Phase 1: STT + TTS + hardcoded response translations
- Scout news feed — live news fetcher, same clean pattern as weather
- Response cleanup layer — post-TinyLlama filter for safety and identity
- Brain Pack upgrades — Phi-2, Llama 3.2, Phi-4, Llama 3.1 8B via Play Asset Delivery
- Robot renaming — user stores their own name for Scout in Settings
- Hardware mode — KEYESTUDIO Mini Tank Kit V2 via Bluetooth (opt-in)
- Inner brow knit while thinking — parked June 8, revisit
- STT phonetic matching — 'Scout' misheard as 'Gal', 'Scott', 'Out'
- Cosmetic expression packs — optional visual personality add-ons
- Full Settings screen — complete implementation of Settings Master Plan

The bottom line

Scout already has a face, a voice, a brain, memory, weather, and a real business model. The gap between today and the Play Store is six focused sessions — not six months.

Scout does not need to be finished to ship. He just needs to be Scout. And he already is.